

JPE Replication Report

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1 Paper Identification

ID	20211186
Author	Morales
Title	Firm Heterogeneity and the Impact of Immigration: Evidence from German Establishments
Iteration	1

Some useful information up front:

- [JPE Data and Code Availability Policy](#)
- [Step by step guidance from Data Editor for Authors](#)
- [Template README](#)

2 Summary

In assessing compliance with our [Data and Code Availability Policy](#), our reproducibility team has identified the following issues, which we ask you to address:

1. Data Editor's first point.
2. Data Editor's second point.

3 General

- ☒ Data Availability and Provenance Statements
 - ☒ Statement about Rights - Part 1: Right to use the data (e.g. *did the authors lawfully obtain the data*)
 - ☒ Statement about Rights - Part 2: Right to publish the data (e.g. *are human subjects involved and did permission been granted to publish their data?*)
 - ☒ License for Data (optional, but recommended)
 - ☒ Details on each Data Source
- ☒ Dataset list
- ☒ Computational requirements
 - ☒ Software Requirements
 - ☒ Controlled Randomness (as necessary)
 - ☒ Memory, Runtime, and Storage Requirements
- ☒ Description of programs/code
 - ☐ License for Code (Optional, but recommended)
- ☒ List of tables and programs
- ☒ References (Optional, but recommended)

4 High-level Description of Research Project

This research project...

- ☒ uses observational data.
- ☒ uses *confidential* observational data.
- ☐ uses data generated via experiment or trial by the authors (in field or lab).
 - ☐ For lab experiments: The code to implement the experimental protocol (z-Tree, o-Tree etc) is included in the package.
 - ☐ A PDF copy of IRB approval is contained in the package.
 - ☐ A PDF document outlining the design of the experiment, including information on the selection and eligibility of participants is included.

- ☐ A PDF copy of the instructions given to participants in both original language and an English translation is included.
- ☐ uses data generated via survey by the authors (in field or online)
 - ☐ The programs used to administer the survey (e.g. qualtrics survey file) are included.
 - ☐ A PDF copy of IRB approval is contained in the package.
 - ☐ A PDF of the original questionnaire(s) and information on the selection and eligibility of participants is included.
- ☐ is a simulation study: the data are generated by an algorithm.
- ☐ is a numerical illustration: no data are used but code is used to produce illustrative output (tables, figures)

5 Data description

For any data that cannot be provided as part of the replication package, please provide the following information as part of the README.

{REQUIRED} Please specify how long the data will be preserved in the restricted-access location.

{REQUIRED} Please provide affirmation of support for replication checks. - As per the [JPE policy](#), "In cases where data cannot be published in an openly accessible trusted data repository like the JPE dataverse, authors who have requested an exemption to publish them at the time of first submission must commit to preserving the data and code for a period of no less than five years following the publication of the paper. They should also provide reasonable assistance to requests for clarification and replication."

{REQUIRED} Please provide a codebook for the data. - The codebook should at a minimum describe the variables obtained from the data source, in a manner that will let others verify that they have obtained a substantially similar dataset if successfully obtaining access to the data.

5.1 Data Sources

file/name	public	private	DOI/URL	Access described	cited readme	cited paper
liab_lm_9314_v1_pers.dta (LIAB LM 9314)	no	yes	https://fdz.iab.de	yes	no	no
liab_lm_9314_v1_bhp_basis_v1.dta (LIAB LM 9314)	no	yes	https://fdz.iab.de	yes	no	no
iabbp_.dta (IAB Establishment Panel, 2004–2012)	no	yes	https://fdz.iab.de	yes	no	no
SIEED_7518_v1.dta	no	yes	https://fdz.iab.de	yes	no	no
SIEED_7518_v1_bhp_basis_v1.dta	no	yes	https://fdz.iab.de	yes	no	no
cpigermany.dta (Destatis CPI)	yes	no	https://www-genesis.destatis.de/datenbank/online/statistik/61111/table/61111-0001	partial	no	no
local labor markets.dta (Kropp & Schwengler concordance)	yes (shipped)	no	-	no	no	yes (article, not data citation)
Onet_Perri_Sparber_beruf_gr.dta	yes	no	https://www.aeaweb.org/articles?id=10.1257/app.1.3.135	partial	no	yes (article, not data citation)
Validation_data.xlsx (aggregated IAB moments)	yes (shipped)	no	-	partial	no	no

file/name	public	private	DOI/URL	Access described	cited readme	cited paper
World Bank WDI series (SL.GDP.PCAP.EM.KD, SP.POP.1564.TO, NY.GDP.PCAP.PP.CD, SP.POP.TOTL)	yes	no	https://data.worldbank.org	yes	no	no
WIOT2012_October16_ROW.dta (WIOD 2012 release)	yes (shipped)	no	-	no	no	yes (article, not data citation)
OECD CSVs (wages, hours, GDP, dependent employees, Germany 2019)	yes (shipped)	no	-	partial	no	no

6 Requirements

- ☒ README is in TXT, MD, or PDF format
- ☒ README is accessible at the root of the package (not inside a folder)
- ☐ Title conforms to guidance (starts with "Data and Code for: Title of Paper" or "Code for: Title of Paper", is properly capitalized)
- ☐ Authors (with affiliations) are listed in the same order as on the paper

{REQUIRED} Please review the title of the deposit as per our guidelines.

{REQUIRED} Please review authors and affiliations on the deposit. In general, they are the same, and in the same order, as for the manuscript; however, authors can deviate from that order.

6.1 Stated Requirements

- ☐ No requirements specified
- ☒ Software Requirements specified as follows:

*"3.1 STATA - Stata 16 or later. (liab_analysis/prog/master.do declares **version 16**.) - User-written packages (install once from SSC):*

ssc install reghdfe // high-dimensional fixed-effects regression

ssc install ivreghdfe // IV/2SLS version of reghdfe

ssc install ftools // dependency of reghdfe/ivreghdfe

ssc install estout // eststo / esttab / estout table export

ssc install grstyle // graph styling (model_analysis plots only)

ssc install grc1leg2 // graph styling (model_analysis plots only)

ivreghdfe additionally relies on ivreg2 and ranktest; if ssc install ivreghdfe does not pull them in, install them as well: ssc install ivreg2 ssc install ranktest

The do-files in calibration_external/ use base Stata only (import Excel, merge, collapse) and require none of the above.

Also, make sure to add the ado files bartik_weight.ado, btsls.ado, and ch_weak.ado, which are not available via ssc install. The codes can be downloaded directly at <https://github.com/paulgp/bartik-weight/tree/master/code>

3.2 MATLAB - MATLAB (R2019b or later recommended) with the Optimization Toolbox. The model solution and calibration use fsolve and fminsearch; the nu-estimation helper files in liab_analysis/prog use fsolve and gamma(). - No additional MATLAB toolboxes are required. "

- ☐ Computational Requirements specified as follows:
 - Cluster size, etc.

- ☒ Time Requirements specified as follows:
 - *"Run time is data-dependent. The empirical part of the model takes close to 5 hours to run on the full data. On the genuine FDZ data, the bootstrap-based do-files (5,000 firm-clustered draws) and the model calibration (SMM via fminsearch) are the slow*

steps.”

☐ Requirements are complete.

For missing requirements, see the list of required changes in [Section 9](#)

7 Analyzing Data and Code Files

7.1 Code description

There are 34 `.do` files. 1 master file at the root, 1 file in the calibration_external folder, 20 for the liab_analysis, 7 for the sieed_analysis, 1 for the model_analysis, and 4 for the stat_plots.

There are 50 `.m` files. 1 master file in the model_analysis, 2 files in the liab_analysis, 1 to export the latex tables, 19 for the heterogeneous-firm model, 15 for the homogeneous (within-sector) model, and 12 for the policy counterfactuals.

The below table presents programs which produce figures or tables.

Exhibit	Folder	Program
Table 1	liab_analysis	19_moments_calculation.do
Table 1 (model side) / Table 2	model_analysis	code/model/Export_latex_tables.m
Tables A1, A2	liab_analysis	17_empirical_facts.do
Tables A3–A5	sieed_analysis	2a_results_event_studies.do
Tables A6–A8	liab_analysis	18_immigrant_comparative_advantage.do
Table C1	liab_analysis	10_epsilon_estimation.do
Tables C2, C4	liab_analysis	15_epsilon_shift_share.do
Table C3	liab_analysis	11_epsilon_pre_trend_test.do
Table C5	liab_analysis	12_epsilon_firm_characteristics.do
Table C6	liab_analysis	16_estimate_nu.do (+ MATLAB nu files)
Table C7	liab_analysis / model_analysis	19_moments_calculation.do / Export_latex_tables.m
Tables C8–C13	liab_analysis	8_validation_regressions.do
Tables D1–D3	model_analysis	code/model/Export_latex_tables.m
Kappa (Appendix C.1)	liab_analysis	9_kappa_estimation.do
Figure 1	liab_analysis	17_empirical_facts.do
Figure 2	sieed_analysis	2a_results_event_studies.do
Figure 3	liab_analysis / model_analysis	8_validation_regressions.do / master.do (Validation_cross_CI_heterog.do)
Figure 4	model_analysis	master.do (Counterfactual_plots_heterog.do)
Figures A1–A4, A6	liab_analysis	17_empirical_facts.do
Figure A5	sieed_analysis	2c_results_figA5.do
Figure A7	sieed_analysis	2b_results_figA7.do
Figure A8	sieed_analysis	2a_results_event_studies.do
Figure A9	liab_analysis	18_immigrant_comparative_advantage.do

- The screenshot displays the Nuvolos application interface. On the left, a sidebar shows the project structure for 'Morales-20211186', including instances, snapshots, overview, files, tables, applications, staging, and a snapshot of the 'Current State'. The main area is divided into three panes: a 'History' pane showing a list of commands and their return codes, a 'Results' pane showing the output of the selected command, and a 'Variables' pane showing the current state of variables.

The 'History' pane lists commands such as:

 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00... 601
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00...
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00... 601
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00...
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00...
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00...
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00... 601
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00... 604
 - pwd
 - ls
 - cd JPE-Morales-2021...
 - ls
 - cd replication-package/
 - ls
 - cd Brinatti_Morales_...
 - ls
 - ls -R
 - log using "mylog", re... 604
 - log close
 - log using "mylog", re...
 - log close
 - log using "file_tree", ...
 - pwd
 - ls
 - ls -R
 - log close
 - translate "file_tree.s...
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00...
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00... 601
 - do "/tmp/SD00027.00... 601

The 'Results' pane shows the output of the selected command, which is a shell script for data replication and analysis. The script includes comments about the event study, sets a seed, and uses the 'log' command to log the results. The 'Variables' pane shows the current state of variables, including 'Name', 'Label', 'Type', 'Format', 'Value label', and 'Notes'.

-
- The screenshot displays the Nuvolet application interface, which is a web-based environment for running R scripts. The interface is divided into several sections:
- Top Bar:** Shows the URL `https://app.eu1.nuvelos.cloud/nuvelos` and the application name "nuvelos".
 - Left Sidebar:** Contains navigation options:
 - SPACE:** Shows the current workspace "Morales-20211186".
 - INSTANCES:** A list of running instances, including "Master".
 - INSTANCE:** A section for managing the selected instance, showing details like "Snapshots", "Overview", "Files", "Tables", "Applications", and "Staging".
 - SNAPSHOT:** A section for managing snapshots, showing the "Current State".
 - Bottom Left:** A "RUNNING" section showing system metrics:
 - STATS:** 8 vCPU, 32 GB memory.
 - Storage:** 4.3 GB of 54.0 GB used (7.98% usage).
 - Main Window:** A command-line interface showing the execution of a do-file script. The script includes commands for setting the working directory, loading data, and running R code. The output shows the script's progress and the final results, including a table of tradeable sectors and their consumption shares.
 - Right Panel:** A "Variables" section showing the current state of variables in the environment, including "Name", "Label", "Type", "Format", "Value label", and "Notes".

- ## Part 2: Analysis using SIEED

9 Findings

9.1 Missing Requirements

The following STATA programs also need to be installed:

- `estout`
- `require`

Computational requirements (i.e. memory and storage) are not specified in the README.

[REQUIRED] Please amend README to contain complete requirements.

9.2 Data Preparation Code

Examples:

- Program `1-create-data.do` ran without error, output expected data
- Program `2-create-appendix-data.do` failed to produce any output.

9.3 Tables and Figures

Exhibit	Folder	Program	Reproduced?	Comment
Table 1	liab_analysis	19_moments_calculation.do	yes	rounding discrepancy on the $\sigma_{\psi,f,NT}$ which equals 30.82 in the paper and 30.83 in the reproduced file.
Table 2	model_analysis	code/model/Export_latex_tables.m	yes	-
Tables A1, A2	liab_analysis	17_empirical_facts.do	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Tables A3–A5	sieed_analysis	2a_results_event_studies.do	no	missing <code>sieed_7518_v1.dta</code>
Tables A6–A8	liab_analysis	18_immigrant_comparative_advantage.do	no	missing <code>Crosswalk_beruf_gr_blossfeld.dta</code>
Table C1	liab_analysis	10_epsilon_estimation.do	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Tables C2, C4	liab_analysis	15_epsilon_shift_share.do	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Table C3	liab_analysis	11_epsilon_pre_trend_test.do	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Table C5	liab_analysis	12_epsilon_firm_characteristics.do	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Table C6	liab_analysis	16_estimate_nu.do (+ MATLAB nu files)	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Table C7	liab_analysis / model_analysis	19_moments_calculation.do / Export_latex_tables.m	yes	rounding discrepancies (paper vs reproduced file). $Var((1 - s_j)/s_j)$, T: simulated 1.31 vs 1.32 $Var((1 - s_j)/s_j)$, NT: simulated 1.43 vs 1.42 data 1.58 vs 1.59. $E(1 - s_{j,p90}) - E(1 - s_{j,p50})$, T: simulated 0.027 vs 0.026. Share of

Exhibit	Folder	Program	Reproduced?	Comment
				firms hiring immigrants, T: simulated 0.62 vs 0.61.
Tables C8–C13	liab_analysis	8_validation_regressions.do	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Tables D1–D3	model_analysis	code/model/Export_latex_tables.m	yes	-
Kappa (Appendix C.1)	liab_analysis	9_kappa_estimation.do	yes	values do not match, to be expected with the LIAB data
Figure 1	liab_analysis	17_empirical_facts.do	yes	structure matches, though values do not. To be expected with the LIAB data.
Figure 2	sieed_analysis	2a_results_event_studies.do	no	missing <code>sieed_7518_v1.dta</code>
Figure 3	liab_analysis / model_analysis	8_validation_regressions.do / master.do (Validation_cross_CI_heterog.do)	no	structure does not match, see comment below
Figure 4	model_analysis	master.do (Counterfactual_plots_heterog.do)	yes	-
Figures A1–A4, A6	liab_analysis	17_empirical_facts.do	yes	structure matches, though values do not. To be expected with the LIAB data.
Figure A5	sieed_analysis	2c_results_figA5.do	no	missing <code>sieed_7518_v1.dta</code>
Figure A7	sieed_analysis	2b_results_figA7.do	no	missing <code>sieed_7518_v1.dta</code>
Figure A8	sieed_analysis	2a_results_event_studies.do	no	missing <code>sieed_7518_v1.dta</code>
Figure A9	liab_analysis	18_immigrant_comparative_advantage.do	no	missing <code>Crosswalk_beruf_gr_blossfeld.dta</code>
Figure C1	liab_analysis	14_epsilon_sigma_histogram.do	yes	structure matches, though values do not. To be expected with the LIAB data.
Figures D1, D2	model_analysis	master.do (Counterfactual_plots_policies.do)	yes	-
Calibration moment GDP_RoW_Ger (~0.32)	calibration_external	gdp_per_worker_*.do	no	calibration exercise did not run due to missing <code>WIOT2012_October16_ROW.dta</code> .
Calibration moment tradeable share (~0.68)	calibration_external	tradeable_consumption_share.do	no	calibration exercise did not run due to missing <code>WIOT2012_October16_ROW.dta</code> .

Comment on the structure of Figure 3:

- Non-Tradable deciles malformed: decile 3 is missing entirely (jumps 2→4, only 9 deciles) and several bins have N=2, so NT can't form 10 plot points. Check on real data.
- Values are raw, pre-normalization: log shows raw firm-mean elasticities; the paper's plotted values are normalized to 0 at decile 1 and rescaled (done downstream), so these won't line up with the figure even in shape.
- Data-side only: the Model line in each panel comes from model_analysis, not this log. The `figure_3.png` in `model_analysis/output/figures/` is empty (0B file).

I copy the output from `8_validation_regressions.log`, for reference.

```
* Table C13 / Figure 3: Mean firm-level elasticity by size decile
. *****
.
```

```
. * Variables: elast_lrev / elast_lrev_T / elast_lrev_NT (fitted revenue elasticity
. *   from 2SLS, evaluated firm-by-firm); elast_ratio / elast_ratio_T / elast_ratio_NT
. *   (fitted wage-bill ratio elasticity); decile_emp / decile_emp_T / decile_emp_NT
. *   (decile of log employment in 2003, defined pooled and by sector)
. * Selection: same sample as Table C9, split by tradeable3
. * Table provides the empirical counterpart to Figure 3 in the paper.
. * FDZ: unweighted counts per decile shown first (via stat(n ...)), then p50 and mean.
.
.
. tabstat elast_lrev_T if tradeable3==1, by(decile_emp) stat(count mean) nototal
```

Summary for variables: elast_lrev_T

Group variable: decile_emp (10 quantiles of logemp_tot_firm03)

decile_emp	N	Mean
1	18	8.998459
2	21	6.214417
3	25	2.944604
4	22	.4690182
5	23	-1.661596
6	15	-2.543755
7	25	-2.700412
8	28	-3.229493
9	17	-2.95027
10	21	-3.535464

```
. tabstat elast_lrev_NT if tradeable3==0, by(decile_emp) stat(count mean) nototal
```

Summary for variables: elast_lrev_NT

Group variable: decile_emp (10 quantiles of logemp_tot_firm03)

decile_emp	N	Mean
1	8	3.131501
2	6	1.387304
4	4	-.236407
5	2	-2.056081
6	11	-1.876087
7	2	-3.50447
8	2	-1.624117
9	4	-1.565133
10	4	-4.521547

```
. tabstat elast_ratio_T if tradeable3==1, by(decile_emp) stat(count mean) nototal
```

Summary for variables: elast_ratio_T

Group variable: decile_emp (10 quantiles of logemp_tot_firm03)

decile_emp	N	Mean
1	18	64.999
2	21	48.45021
3	25	30.27999
4	22	13.70009
5	23	2.17356
6	15	-1.397829
7	25	-3.220492
8	28	-5.009644
9	17	-5.141996
10	21	-9.522139

```
. tabstat elast_ratio_NT if tradeable3==0, by(decile_emp) stat(count mean) nototal
```

Summary for variables: elast_ratio_NT

Group variable: decile_emp (10 quantiles of logemp_tot_firm03)

decile_emp	N	Mean
------------	---	------

1		8	1.14822
2		6	.8691236
4		4	1.489105
5		2	2.8191
6		11	1.999086
7		2	3.385747
8		2	1.530998
9		4	1.459541
10		4	2.643406

```

.
.
.
.
. log close
  name: <unnamed>
  log: /files/JPE-Morales-20211186/replication-package/Brinatti_Morales_Replication_Package/liab_analysis/log/8
log type: text
closed on: 7 Jul 2026, 14:58:47

```

9.4 In-Text Numbers

- ☐ In-text numbers not verified.
- ☐ There are no in-text numbers, or all in-text numbers stem from tables and figures.
- ☐ There are in-text numbers, but they are not identified in the code
- ☒ The below in-text numbers have been verified.

Section 6.1 aggregates and dollar gains

"that the welfare of native workers would increase by 0.11%, representing \$1.8 billion for the aggregate economy."

(...)

"The welfare gains of firm owners (1.31%) are larger than those of native workers"

(...)

"Total income, which includes earnings for all workers and profits, increases by 1.28% or \$22.5 billion."

Section 6.3 decomposition

"which is 9% (0.010 pp) larger than"

(...)

"implying that terms-of-trade effects reduce the gains from immigration by 0.004 pp (approximately 39% of the total dampening effect)."

(...)

"The remaining 61% of the total dampening effects (0.006 pp) is due to the heterogeneity in immigrant shares across firms within sectors, as illustrated in equation 16."

9.5 Other Issues

It is difficult for the replicator to comment on the exact reproducibility of the paper as some `.dta` files are missing and because of the FDZ dummy data.

10 Classification

- ☐ full reproduction
- ☐ full reproduction with minor issues

- ☒ partial reproduction (see above)
- ☐ not able to reproduce most or all of the results (reasons see above)

10.1 Reason for incomplete reproducibility

- ☐ None.
- ☐ **Discrepancy in output** (either figures or numbers in tables or text differ)
- ☐ **Bugs in code** that were fixable by the replicator (but should be fixed in the final deposit)
- ☐ **Code missing**, in particular if it prevented the replicator from completing the reproducibility check
 - ☐ **Data preparation code missing** should be checked if the code missing seems to be data preparation code
- ☐ **Code not functional** is more severe than a simple bug: it prevented the replicator from completing the reproducibility check
- ☐ **Software not available to replicator** may happen for a variety of reasons, but in particular (a) when the software is commercial, and the replicator does not have access to a licensed copy, or (b) the software is open-source, but a specific version required to conduct the reproducibility check is not available.
- ☐ **Insufficient time available to replicator** is applicable when (a) running the code would take weeks or more (b) running the code might take less time if sufficient compute resources were to be brought to bear, but no such resources can be accessed in a timely fashion (c) the replication package is very complex, and following all (manual and scripted) steps would take too long.
- ☒ **Data missing** is marked when data *should* be available, but was erroneously not provided, or is not accessible via the procedures described in the replication package
- ☐ **Data not available** is marked when data requires additional access steps, for instance purchase or application procedure.
- ☐ **Missing README** is marked if there is no README to guide the replicator, or the README is not in compliance with JPE requirements